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God Is Holy

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God Is Holy

He is perfectly pure and set apart from all sin.

Isaiah's Vision of the Throne (Isaiah 6:1-7)

In the year King Uzziah died, the prophet Isaiah saw the Lord seated on a high and lofty throne. Seraphim cried out, "Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of Heaven's Armies! The whole earth is full of his glory!." Overwhelmed by God's holiness, Isaiah confessed his own uncleanness, and a seraph touched his lips with a live coal from the altar, cleansing him. This vision reveals God's perfect purity that exposes sin and provides cleansing.

The Burning Bush and Holy Ground (Exodus 3:1-6)

While tending sheep, Moses encountered the angel of the LORD in a bush that burned but was not consumed. God said, "Do not approach any closer! Take your sandals off your feet, for the place where you are standing is holy ground." This encounter underscores that God's presence makes ordinary places sacred and demands reverence because of His perfect holiness.

God's Judgment on Profane Worship (Leviticus 10:1-3)

When Nadab and Abihu offered "strange fire" before the Lord, fire came out from the LORD's presence and consumed them. Moses explained, "This is what the LORD has said: 'I will show myself holy among those who are near me, and I will glorify myself before all the people'." This solemn event illustrates that God's holiness cannot be treated casually and demands pure worship.

God's Command to His People (Leviticus 19:2; 1 Peter 1:15-16)

The Lord declared to Israel, "You must be holy because I, the LORD your God, am holy." This command, repeated in the New Testament, shows that God's holiness is not only His own nature but the standard to which He calls His people. It flows from His absolute separation from sin and complete devotion to righteousness.

The Heavenly Worship in Revelation (Revelation 4:8)

The four living creatures around the throne never cease saying, "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord God Almighty, who was and who is and who is still to come!." This eternal anthem in heaven reveals that God's holiness is central to the worship of all creation, both now and forever.

Daily Impact

Holiness first humbles, then steadies. It will not let us treat God as common, useful, or safe on our terms. The vision that made Isaiah cry “Woe is me” is the same holiness that cleansed his lips. So this attribute does two works in a single day. It searches us. It also makes a way for us to live before His face.

We learn to hate what He hates and to love what He loves. Worship becomes more than a mood. Speech becomes more careful. Hidden corners are brought into the light, not to be crushed, but to be made clean.

Daily we remember that the God who is holy has called us to be holy—not as a ladder we climb to reach Him, but as the family likeness of those already brought near in Christ.

Because God is holy, I will give Him wholehearted reverence and devotion.

Questions for Personal Application

1. Where have I been treating God as common—useful, casual, or small—rather than taking off my sandals before the Holy One?
2. What uncleanness has His light already named, and will I confess it instead of managing it?
3. How should the cry “Holy, holy, holy” change the way I worship this week, in gathered praise and in secret?
4. In what ordinary place—speech, screens, work, or relationships—am I being called to be holy as He is holy?
5. Whom can I remind that holiness is not only a warning, but also a mercy: the God who exposes also cleanses?

Word Pictures of God’s Holiness

The Cry That Does Not End

In heaven they do not grow tired of one word. “Holy, holy, holy.” Not “mighty” three times. Not “love” three times. Holiness is the burning center of God’s glory. Every other perfection shines from that fire. This is the strongest picture because Scripture itself will not replace it.

Sandals Off on Ordinary Ground

The bush is still a bush. The dirt is still dirt. Then God is there, and Moses must not walk as he walked a moment before. Holiness does not always first look like lightning. It can meet a man at work and turn the workplace into holy ground. Reverence is the only sane response.

The Coal That Burns and Cleanses

Isaiah is not complimented in the throne room. He is undone. Then a live coal touches his mouth. Holiness is not only the fire that exposes. It is the fire that purifies. The same God who cannot abide uncleanness provides the cleansing we cannot invent.

Reflection

These pictures remind us that holiness is not an accessory of God. It is the fire at the center. Heaven has not found a higher word than “holy.” Ordinary ground becomes holy when He is there, and sandals must come off. The same fire that undoes the sinner is the fire that touches the lips and makes them clean. Because He is holy, we cannot treat Him as common. Because He is holy *and* merciful, we need not flee the light. We take off what does not belong. We confess what the cry exposes. We receive the coal we could not supply.

1. What would change in my worship if I let heaven’s unfinished cry—“Holy, holy, holy”—set the tone rather than my mood?
2. Where am I still walking with sandals on—treating as common the place, the speech, or the work where God is present?
3. Will I let the coal do its two works this week: exposing what is unclean, and cleansing what I cannot clean myself?

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In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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